

FRIENDSHIP SPEAKER'S CIRCLE

CLUB SUCCESS PLAN

2026–2027 Program Year

Conversations that Matter.

Speak. Connect. Grow. Lead.

Club	Friendship Speaker's Circle
Program Year	July 1, 2026 – June 30, 2027
Club Number	_____
Primary Recognition Target	President's Distinguished
Stretch Target	Smedley Distinguished

Prepared for the Club Executive Committee • August 25, 2026

Executive Summary

Purpose. This plan turns the Distinguished Club Program into a yearlong operating plan for member growth, club quality, leadership, and measurable follow-through.

OUR 2026–2027 NORTH STAR

Member Experience	Education	Membership	Leadership & Operations
Prepared meetings, supportive feedback, mentoring, recognition	Steady Pathways progress and visible milestones	Recruit, onboard, engage, and retain members	Trained officers, on-time administration, action ownership

Recognition Target

Primary target: President's Distinguished — submit the Club Success Plan by September 30, finish with at least 20 members, and achieve at least 9 of 10 DCP goals.

Stretch target: Smedley Distinguished — finish with at least 25 members and achieve all 10 goals.

Official DCP requirements for 2026–2027 are based on Toastmasters International guidance effective July 1, 2026.

Club Operating Priorities

- Make every meeting feel prepared, welcoming, purposeful, and worth attending.
- Use the club website, Member Hub, calendar, role resources, speech submission form, feedback survey, and progress tracker as the club's operating system.
- Move members through Pathways intentionally instead of waiting for progress to happen on its own.
- Use board mentors and the Club Mentor to keep members connected and supported.
- Recognize courage, growth, service, consistency, and leadership throughout the year.
- End board discussions with an owner, due date, and next step.

2026–2027 Distinguished Club Program Goals

Goal	Area	DCP Requirement	Lead Owner	Internal Target
1	Education	Four Level 1 awards achieved	William Foster, VPE	Dec. 31, 2026
2	Education	Two Level 2 awards achieved	William Foster, VPE	Jan. 31, 2027
3	Education	Two more Level 2 awards achieved	William Foster, VPE	Apr. 30, 2027
4	Education	Two Level 3 awards achieved	William Foster, VPE	May 31, 2027
5	Education	One Level 4, Path Completion, or DTM award achieved	William Foster, VPE	May 31, 2027
6	Education	One more Level 4, Path Completion, or DTM award achieved	William Foster, VPE	June 15, 2027
7	Membership	Four new, dual, or reinstating members	Brandy Winchester, VPM	Dec. 31, 2026

Goal	Area	DCP Requirement	Lead Owner	Internal Target
8	Membership	Four more new, dual, or reinstating members	Brandy Winchester, VPM	May 31, 2027
9	Training	At least four club officer roles trained in each of the two training periods	Abdul Dopson, President	Both periods
10	Administration	On-time dues for one renewal period + on-time officer list	Tatiana Peters, Treasurer / President	By official deadlines

QUALIFYING REQUIREMENTS

Requirement	2026–2027 Rule	Club Plan
Club Success Plan	Submit by September 30, 2026	Complete and submit before deadline
Membership	20 total members OR qualifying net growth for Distinguished; higher levels have higher thresholds	Track paid membership monthly; target 20+ by spring and 25 as stretch
Good Standing	Club must remain in good standing	Monitor dues, officer list, and minimum paid-member requirements

DCP Goal 1: Four Level 1 awards achieved

Lead owner: William Foster, VPE | **Internal target:** Dec. 31, 2026

Strategy

- Review the Pathways Progress Tracker at least monthly and identify the next likely completions.
- Use the speech submission form to connect scheduled speeches to Pathways projects and project timing.
- Prioritize members who are one or two projects away from a level completion.
- Board mentors check in with assigned members and help remove barriers to completing the next project.
- Celebrate level completions at meetings and record them in the Awards Tracker.
- Approve completed levels promptly so progress reaches the DCP dashboard.

Checkpoint

By September: identify at least 6 members actively working toward Level 1; by November: at least 2 Level 1 awards; by December 31: 4 completed.

Evidence to Review

- Pathways Progress Tracker
- Speech Submission Form responses
- Toastmasters DCP dashboard
- Awards Tracker

DCP Goal 2: Two Level 2 awards achieved

Lead owner: William Foster, VPE | **Internal target:** Jan. 31, 2027

Strategy

- Review the Pathways Progress Tracker at least monthly and identify the next likely completions.
- Use the speech submission form to connect scheduled speeches to Pathways projects and project timing.
- Prioritize members who are one or two projects away from a level completion.
- Board mentors check in with assigned members and help remove barriers to completing the next project.
- Celebrate level completions at meetings and record them in the Awards Tracker.
- Approve completed levels promptly so progress reaches the DCP dashboard.

Checkpoint

Maintain a visible pipeline of members approaching Level 2 and reserve prepared-speech slots for them each month.

Evidence to Review

- Pathways Progress Tracker
- Speech Submission Form responses
- Toastmasters DCP dashboard
- Awards Tracker

DCP Goal 3: Two more Level 2 awards achieved

Lead owner: William Foster, VPE | **Internal target:** Apr. 30, 2027

Strategy

- Review the Pathways Progress Tracker at least monthly and identify the next likely completions.
- Use the speech submission form to connect scheduled speeches to Pathways projects and project timing.

- Prioritize members who are one or two projects away from a level completion.
- Board mentors check in with assigned members and help remove barriers to completing the next project.
- Celebrate level completions at meetings and record them in the Awards Tracker.
- Approve completed levels promptly so progress reaches the DCP dashboard.

Checkpoint

Maintain a visible pipeline of members approaching Level 2 and reserve prepared-speech slots for them each month.

Evidence to Review

- Pathways Progress Tracker
- Speech Submission Form responses
- Toastmasters DCP dashboard
- Awards Tracker

DCP Goal 4: Two Level 3 awards achieved

Lead owner: William Foster, VPE | **Internal target:** May 31, 2027

Strategy

- Review the Pathways Progress Tracker at least monthly and identify the next likely completions.
- Use the speech submission form to connect scheduled speeches to Pathways projects and project timing.
- Prioritize members who are one or two projects away from a level completion.
- Board mentors check in with assigned members and help remove barriers to completing the next project.
- Celebrate level completions at meetings and record them in the Awards Tracker.
- Approve completed levels promptly so progress reaches the DCP dashboard.

Checkpoint

By February: identify at least 3 members positioned for Level 3; by May: secure 2 completions.

Evidence to Review

- Pathways Progress Tracker
- Speech Submission Form responses
- Toastmasters DCP dashboard
- Awards Tracker

DCP Goal 5: One Level 4, Path Completion, or DTM award achieved

Lead owner: William Foster, VPE | **Internal target:** May 31, 2027

Strategy

- Review the Pathways Progress Tracker at least monthly and identify the next likely completions.
- Use the speech submission form to connect scheduled speeches to Pathways projects and project timing.
- Prioritize members who are one or two projects away from a level completion.
- Board mentors check in with assigned members and help remove barriers to completing the next project.
- Celebrate level completions at meetings and record them in the Awards Tracker.
- Approve completed levels promptly so progress reaches the DCP dashboard.

Checkpoint

Identify advanced members early and protect speaking/project opportunities needed to reach Level 4, Path Completion, or DTM milestones.

Evidence to Review

- Pathways Progress Tracker
- Speech Submission Form responses
- Toastmasters DCP dashboard
- Awards Tracker

DCP Goal 6: One more Level 4, Path Completion, or DTM award achieved

Lead owner: William Foster, VPE | **Internal target:** June 15, 2027

Strategy

- Review the Pathways Progress Tracker at least monthly and identify the next likely completions.

- Use the speech submission form to connect scheduled speeches to Pathways projects and project timing.
- Prioritize members who are one or two projects away from a level completion.
- Board mentors check in with assigned members and help remove barriers to completing the next project.
- Celebrate level completions at meetings and record them in the Awards Tracker.
- Approve completed levels promptly so progress reaches the DCP dashboard.

Checkpoint

Identify advanced members early and protect speaking/project opportunities needed to reach Level 4, Path Completion, or DTM milestones.

Evidence to Review

- Pathways Progress Tracker
- Speech Submission Form responses
- Toastmasters DCP dashboard
- Awards Tracker

DCP Goal 7: Four new, dual, or reinstating members

Lead owner: Brandy Winchester, VPM | **Internal target:** Dec. 31, 2026

Strategy

- Use the Interest Form as the single intake point for prospective members.
- Invite guests consistently through member referrals, Friendship communications, and club promotion.
- Follow up with guests within 48 hours of a meeting and give a clear next step.
- Use a structured Start Here onboarding process and assign a board mentor quickly.
- Offer meaningful low-risk meeting roles early so new members participate instead of only observing.
- Track retention as seriously as recruitment; personally reconnect with members whose participation drops.

Checkpoint

Goal 7: 4 qualifying members by December 31. Goal 8: an additional 4 by May 31, while protecting retention and paid-member thresholds.

Evidence to Review

- Interest Form responses
- Member roster / paid membership
- Attendance Tracker
- Onboarding follow-up notes

DCP Goal 8: Four more new, dual, or reinstating members

Lead owner: Brandy Winchester, VPM | **Internal target:** May 31, 2027

Strategy

- Use the Interest Form as the single intake point for prospective members.
- Invite guests consistently through member referrals, Friendship communications, and club promotion.
- Follow up with guests within 48 hours of a meeting and give a clear next step.
- Use a structured Start Here onboarding process and assign a board mentor quickly.
- Offer meaningful low-risk meeting roles early so new members participate instead of only observing.
- Track retention as seriously as recruitment; personally reconnect with members whose participation drops.

Checkpoint

Goal 7: 4 qualifying members by December 31. Goal 8: an additional 4 by May 31, while protecting retention and paid-member thresholds.

Evidence to Review

- Interest Form responses
- Member roster / paid membership
- Attendance Tracker
- Onboarding follow-up notes

DCP Goal 9: At least four club officer roles trained in each of the two training periods

Lead owner: Abdul Dopson, President | **Internal target:** Both periods

Strategy

- Track officer training completion by officer role, not just by individual officer.
- Aim for all officers trained during each period; never plan around the minimum of four.
- Share training dates early, require officers to report completion, and store certificates/records in the Officer Hub.
- Use training takeaways as short board-learning segments so the training changes club practice.

Checkpoint

Complete at least four trained officer roles in each official training period; internal standard is 100% officer participation whenever possible.

Evidence to Review

- Officer training confirmations/certificates
- Officer Hub training folder
- DCP dashboard

DCP Goal 10: On-time dues for one renewal period + on-time officer list

Lead owner: Tatiana Peters, Treasurer / President | **Internal target:** By official deadlines

Strategy

- Confirm renewal responsibilities and deadlines well before the official due date.
- Maintain at least eight paid members for the qualifying dues submission, including at least three renewing members where required.
- Verify the officer list is submitted on time and matches the current executive committee.
- Use the Officer Hub to document completion and keep administrative evidence in one protected location.
- Do not wait until the deadline day for dues or officer-list submissions.

Checkpoint

Complete the qualifying dues submission and officer list early enough to correct any errors before the official deadline.

Evidence to Review

- Club Central confirmation
- Treasurer records
- Officer list confirmation
- DCP dashboard

Member Experience & Club Quality Plan

Meeting Quality

- Use the standardized meeting flow and explicit handoffs so the room always knows who has control.
- Start and end on time; publish the agenda and fill roles in advance.
- Use the role resource drive so members do not have to guess how to perform an assignment.
- Keep Table Topics, evaluations, timing reports, and recognition moving with purpose and energy.
- Use the feedback survey after meetings and review patterns at board meetings.

New Member Experience

- Interest Form → personal outreach → guest visit → membership decision → Start Here onboarding.
- Assign a board mentor and help the member identify a first role and first speech/project.
- Show the member where the Member Hub, calendar, Pathways resources, role resources, and progress tracker live.
- Check in during the first month to ensure the member is participating, not merely enrolled.

Recognition & Culture

- Recognize Member of the Month, Speech Spotlight, Pathways achievements, service, growth, and leadership.
- Use the annual Golden Buzzer for exceptional club impact—not perfection.
- Celebrate milestones publicly while keeping private membership/attendance records protected.
- Use recognition to reinforce the culture the club wants repeated.

Executive Committee Accountability

Role	Leader	Success-Plan Responsibility
President	Abdul Dopson	Own club direction, DCP review, officer accountability, board effectiveness, and submission of the Club Success Plan.
Vice President Education	William Foster	Own education goals, Pathways pipeline, speech scheduling, role readiness, and education progress.
Vice President Membership	Brandy Winchester	Own recruitment, guest follow-up, onboarding, engagement, retention, and membership growth goals.
Vice President Public Relations	Monique Miller	Own club visibility, communication, recruitment promotion, storytelling, and awareness of club events.
Secretary	Vacant	When filled: own minutes, records, documentation, decisions, and action-item follow-through.
Treasurer	Tatiana Peters	Own dues monitoring, payment coordination, financial records, and administrative support for Goal 10.
Sergeant at Arms	Neko Ramos	Own meeting readiness, opening/closing standards, logistics, and a welcoming environment.

Role	Leader	Success-Plan Responsibility
Club Mentor	Kimbaley	Support club-level quality, leadership development, sustainability, and officer growth.

Board Review Rhythm

When	Review	Decision Required	Output
Every board meeting	Open action items, membership, upcoming meeting readiness	What needs an owner or escalation?	Updated action tracker
Monthly	DCP dashboard + Pathways tracker + attendance + interest form	Which goals are on/off track?	30-day priorities
Quarterly	All 10 DCP goals + member experience	What strategy needs to change?	Quarterly reset
April–June	Membership threshold, advanced awards, dues/admin	What must close before June 30?	Year-end closeout plan

2026–2027 Milestone Calendar

Month	Primary Success-Plan Focus
August 2026	Finalize club systems, officer training participation, website/member tools, role sign-up, mentor assignments.
September 2026	Executive Committee approves Club Success Plan; submit by September 30; establish Pathways completion pipeline.
October 2026	Renewals/administration check; launch focused recruitment and onboarding cycle; verify meeting cadence.
November 2026	Review first-quarter DCP progress; target at least 2 Level 1 awards; follow up with inactive members.
December 2026	Target Goal 7 membership growth and 4 Level 1 awards; recognize first-semester achievements.
January 2027	Second-half reset; identify Level 2/3/4 pipeline; relaunch member goals and mentor check-ins.
February 2027	Complete second officer-training requirement; strengthen advanced Pathways scheduling.
March 2027	Quarterly DCP review; spring recruitment; identify any missing goals early.
April 2027	Renewal/admin readiness; protect member count; accelerate remaining education goals.
May 2027	Close membership Goals 7–8 and advanced education goals; no new goal should remain without a named plan.
June 2027	Complete all submissions well before June 30; verify DCP dashboard and year-end membership threshold.

Initial Action Plan

Action	Owner	Due	Status	Success Evidence
Approve this Club Success Plan	Executive Committee	September 9, 2026	Not Started	Board meeting approval and revisions captured
Submit Club Success Plan to Toastmasters	President	September 25, 2026	Not Started	Submitted before Sept. 30 deadline
Confirm membership base and current paid count	VPM + Treasurer	September 15, 2026	Not Started	Membership target documented
Complete/verify first officer training period	President + All Officers	September 15, 2026	In Progress	At least 4 officer roles; internal target all officers
Identify Level 1 completion pipeline	VPE	September 15, 2026	Not Started	At least 6 members identified
Assign/confirm board mentors	President + Board	September 15, 2026	Not Started	Every active member has a support connection
Launch monthly DCP dashboard review	President + VPE	September 30, 2026	Not Started	DCP standing reviewed monthly
Establish guest follow-up routine	VPM + VPPR	September 30, 2026	Not Started	Every guest receives follow-up within 48 hours

Action	Owner	Due	Status	Success Evidence
Review feedback survey patterns	Executive Committee	Monthly	Recurring	One improvement action selected as needed
Fill Secretary vacancy	President + Board	October 31, 2026	Not Started	Secretary elected/appointed per club rules
Complete second officer training period	President + All Officers	February 28, 2027	Not Started	At least 4 officer roles; internal target all officers
Year-end DCP closeout review	Executive Committee	June 1, 2027	Not Started	Remaining gaps assigned and deadline-protected

Monthly Dashboard

Metric	Current	Target
Paid members	_____	20+ primary / 25 stretch
New/dual/reinstating members this year	_____	8+
Level 1 awards	_____	4
Level 2 awards	_____	4
Level 3 awards	_____	2
Level 4 / Path Completion / DTM awards	_____	2
Officer training - Period 1	_____	4+ roles
Officer training - Period 2	_____	4+ roles
DCP goals achieved	_____	9 primary / 10 stretch
Average meeting attendance	_____	Track trend + retention
Open board action items	_____	Declining / on-time closure

Executive Committee Commitment

We will use this plan as a working document, review progress regularly, adjust strategy when evidence shows a need, and keep member growth at the center of club decisions.

President: Abdul Dopson	Signature/Date: _____
Vice President Education: William Foster	Signature/Date: _____
Vice President Membership: Brandy Winchester	Signature/Date: _____
Vice President Public Relations: Monique Miller	Signature/Date: _____
Club Mentor: Kimbaley	Signature/Date: _____

Official Reference Notes

Toastmasters International, Distinguished Club Program Manual (updated June 2026; effective July 1, 2026). <https://www.toastmasters.org/membership/leadership/club-officer-tools/distinguished-club-program-manual>

Toastmasters International, Distinguished Club Program FAQ.

<https://www.toastmasters.org/footer/faq/Distinguished%20Club%20Program>

Toastmasters International, Club Success Plan. <https://www.toastmasters.org/membership/leadership/club-officer-tools/club-success-plan>

Toastmasters International, Pathways Achievements and Awards.

<https://www.toastmasters.org/education/pathways/achievements-and-awards>

Prepared August 25, 2026. Verify official deadlines and dashboard status in Club Central / Toastmasters dashboards throughout the program year.